Chart of Accounts & GL Coding Guide

DATE October 1, 2026
PREPARED BY Northlake University

Provided by: Northlake University Finance & Accounts Payable. Synthetic/ illustrative values. This describes how we want utility and energy costs coded so approved costs can be exported to our financial system for payment.

Financial system

Northlake Finance runs a PeopleSoft-based financials/ERP. We need approved utility costs delivered to it as:

1. An **AP voucher** interface (for payment), and
2. A **GL journal** interface (for internal cost distribution, including the thermal plant allocations).

We currently produce these from spreadsheets by hand; automating them is a priority. Please confirm the file layout your system can produce against our ERP's import format during the design phase.

Chart of accounts (expense + control)

GL account	Type	Description
5100-ELEC	Expense	Electricity expense
5110-GAS	Expense	Natural gas expense
5120-WATER	Expense	Water / sewer / stormwater expense
5130-THERMAL	Expense	Chilled water / steam (internal allocation)
5140-SOLAR	Expense	Solar PPA expense
5150-WIND	Expense	Ridgeline wind energy transfer (internal)
2000-AP	Liability	Accounts payable control

Cost-coding segments

Every cost line is coded with our **five segments** in addition to the GL account:

Segment	Examples
Fund	110 Operating, 250 Auxiliary, 700 Plant
Department	Facilities, Housing, Athletics, Labs
Program	Instruction, Research, Residential, Administration
Activity / Project	(project or activity code, where applicable)

Segment	Examples
Object	(object code)

How costs map to coding

Property / source	GL account	Fund	Department
Main Campus buildings (electric/gas/water)	by commodity	110 Operating	Facilities
Science Center labs	by commodity	110 Operating	Labs
Cedar Row Apartments	by commodity	250 Auxiliary	Housing
Thermal plant allocations (six cost centers, one per served building)	5130-THERMAL	700 Plant	Facilities
Solar PPA	5140-SOLAR	110 Operating	Facilities
Ridgeline transfer statement	5150-WIND	700 Plant	Ridgeline Wind
Ridgeline generator account (Valley Electric)	5100-ELEC	700 Plant	Ridgeline Wind

Some segment values are intentionally left blank on certain accounts (e.g. Activity/Project) — that is expected, not an error.

AP setup

- Each utility account should be flagged for the right interface: most are **AP upload**; campus electric and thermal accounts are **both AP and GL**; one Cedar Row account is intentionally **no upload** (kept off the interface as a control).
- Ridgeline's transfer statement is **GL only**: it is a journal between the plant and its own wind company, and no payment leaves the plant. The Valley Electric generator account pays only its own small charges: its export credit moves to the Central Plant account (the bill credit transfer), so code the credit once, where it lands.
- A bill should not be exported until it is **approved** (see access request — the person who enters a bill is not the person who approves it), and a bill with an open validation alert must be **held** from export.

Open items

- Confirm the exact ERP import layout for the AP voucher and GL journal.
- Confirm object codes per commodity.
- Confirm whether the solar PPA posts to AP or is handled as a separate agreement.
- The Thermal Plant runs as its own operating company with its own electric, gas and water accounts at the Central Plant; confirm how those accounts are coded (the table above covers only its allocations).